of a banker. There was protracted correspondence between Sir Dinshaw and Masani over many years in which the former constantly complained against Sorabji. Sir Dinshaw's main grievance was that the Directors were deliberately being kept in the dark about various matters. In October 1926, he wrote to Masani hoping that he would not become 'one of the secret confederacy to hoodwink the directors or keep them in the dark.'[2] He went on to add, 'There is a good deal of the spirit of speculation in Sorabji which must be extinguished. Banks are ruined by speculative managers.'[3] In another letter in November he wrote that Sorabji did not realize that the more he kept the Board correctly informed the lesser was his responsibility. 'He fails yet to realize that keeping the Board in darkness will eventually recoil on his head.'[4]

When Masani joined the bank in 1925, it was Sorabji himself along with the Chairman, Sir Phiroze Sethna, who persuaded him to accept the job. Masani, an administrator who had distinguished himself as the Member Secretary of the Bombay Municipal Corporation, was understandably circumspect about taking the job. Masani's misgivings about having no previous banking experience was countered by Sorabji and Sir Phiroze Sethna by citing a precedent in which a high-ranking officer of the ICS had been appointed to a top banking position. It was suggested that Masani visit London for studying the principles and current practices of banking. Masani duly sailed to England and after a year and a half's stay there returned in 1926, eager to serve the Central Bank. But it was not to be. Masani's differences with Sorabji cut short his career in the bank, touched by what Sir Phiroze Sethna called 'this unfortunate matter.'[5]

Even when Masani had been in England, he had sensed from the tenor of Sorabji's correspondence that all was not well. Sorabji evinced no interest in his studies and made no enquiries as to his progress. As Masani was to discover later, Sorabji had more than his share of worries. Some of the Directors, particularly Sir Dinshaw, had been unhappy with certain issues and had instituted enquiries into matters in regard to which Sorabji as the Managing Director had been given a free hand. A Retrenchment Committee of the Directors had been formed from which Sorabji was excluded. Masani was also widely perceived to be Sir Dinshaw's protégé and Masani got the feeling that with him (Masani) at the bank, Sorabji was probably under the impression that some of the Directors did not think that he (Sorabji) was as